

5.5.1 Functions of Equity and Equal Access

انصاف اور مساوی رسائی کے چار کام ہیں: ضرورت کے مطابق مدد (جیسے نابینا طالب علم کے لیے آڈیو وضاحت)، رکاوٹیں ہٹانا...

CS XII

Chapter 5: Application and Impacts of Computing

Lecture 15 of 17

★ Golden

5.5.1 Functions of Equity and Equal Access ★ Golden

LEARN IT

Equity and equal access are not slogans. They **do work** in a digital classroom. The source lists four functions.

Function	What it does	Pakistani example
1. Providing need-based support (equity)	Help tailored to individuals.	Audio descriptions for visually impaired students; a screen reader so a blind student in Karachi can hear a digital textbook.
2. Removing barriers	Help students in remote areas attend online classes.	Mobile-friendly, low-data apps so a student in Tharparkar or the katcha areas of Sindh can join without a fibre connection.
3. Enabling active participation	Students who miss live class can still take part.	Recorded lectures so load-shedding or an internet outage in Hyderabad does not make a student fall behind.
4. Supporting different learning needs	Offer more than one format.	Videos, text notes and audio of the same Chapter 5 topic so each student learns in the way that suits them best.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Worked example: design four functions for one class WhatsApp + Classroom group in Nawabshah.

- Need-based support:** Ali is visually impaired — share materials as selectable text (not only photos) so a screen reader can speak them; add a short audio description of each diagram.
- Remove barriers:** post a 5 MB audio summary instead of a 200 MB video for students on expensive mobile data.
- Active participation:** upload the Zoom recording within an hour; students whose lights went out at 7 pm watch it at 11 pm.
- Different learning needs:** the same lesson as (a) a 12-minute video, (b) a one-page PDF, (c) an Urdu audio note.

Discussion from the source: if a teacher **only** accepts assignments via an app that needs a **high-end smartphone**, is that equal access? **No**. It creates a **hardware barrier** for lower-income students. Web-based or light apps give better access.

REMEMBER IT

Four functions: Support, Remove, Participate, Formats. “Some Rural Pupils Fail” without them — Support (need-based), Remove barriers, Participate via recordings, Formats (video/text/audio).

COMMON MISTAKE

Mistake: Describing only captions and stopping.

Fix: Examiners want all four functions. Include remote-area low-data apps, recorded lectures for power cuts, and multiple formats — these are in the Sindh source on purpose.

اردو میں سمجھیں

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EXAM TIP

Golden question: “Explain the functions of equity and equal access in digital collaboration” (5–8 marks). Write the four headings in order, one example each, and add the hardware-barrier point (high-end app vs light/web app). Another favourite: “Differentiate equal access and equity with examples” — same login vs captions.

CHECK YOURSELF

- List the four functions of equity and equal access.
- How do recorded lectures enable active participation in Pakistan?
- Why is a high-end-smartphone-only assignment unfair?

Answers: 1. Need-based support; removing barriers; enabling active participation; supporting different learning needs. 2. Students who face power or internet outages can watch later and not fall behind. 3. It creates a hardware barrier for lower-income students; web-based or light apps give better access.

Next lecture: 5.5.2 Collaboration Tools